

TOPIC 3: MEANING AND USE OF MOTIFS (PART 1)

1. Meaning of Motif and Pattern

A **motif** is a repeated decorative unit or design element (e.g. a leaf, geometric shape, symbol). A **pattern** is the overall design created when motifs are repeated in an organised way.

2. Uses of Motifs

- Textile design (Adire, printed fabrics, embroidery)
- Pottery, ceramics and body decoration
- Architecture and interior decoration
- Graphic design, logos and packaging
- Cultural identity and storytelling through symbols

3. Summary

Motifs are building blocks of pattern. They are used across crafts, design and cultural expression.

End of Topic 3